

MUSICAL NOTES

For Vamsi Krishna, CEO and Co-founder of Vedantu, playing the flute literally means staying true to his name

BY SMITA TRIPATHI



PHOTO BY SUDHIR DAMERLA

MUSICAL JOURNEY Vamsi Krishna learnt to play the flute in his final year of college at IIT Bombay

VAMSİ KRISHNA, the 39-year-old CEO and Co-founder of Vedantu—an edtech company—believes in keeping himself energised. “Balance of energy is important. It’s why I like to dabble in some passion or the other,” says the IIT Bombay alumnus. Playing the flute is one of them. “It’s a funny story about why I started playing the flute. My name, Vamsi, means flute in Telugu,” smiles Krishna, adding that his mother is from Andhra Pradesh and had named him. “Subconsciously it was always there that maybe I should learn to play the flute,” he laughs, saying that it was only in the final year of college that he joined a music club on campus and learnt

the basics of playing the flute. “I never realised it was going to be such a tough instrument. Unlike a guitar or a piano where you can get some sound even if not melodious, in a flute just getting any kind of sound is difficult.”

Over the years, he has played it sporadically. “I am basically self-taught. Like any other instrument, in case of the flute, too, it’s a function of how much input time you put in—that much finesse you will get out of it.” He doesn’t get to practise as much as he would like to, but during the pandemic he did enjoy a lot of me-time playing the flute on his terrace. “It is extremely de-stressing,” he adds. Krishna plays self-compositions rather than any fixed ragas or songs.